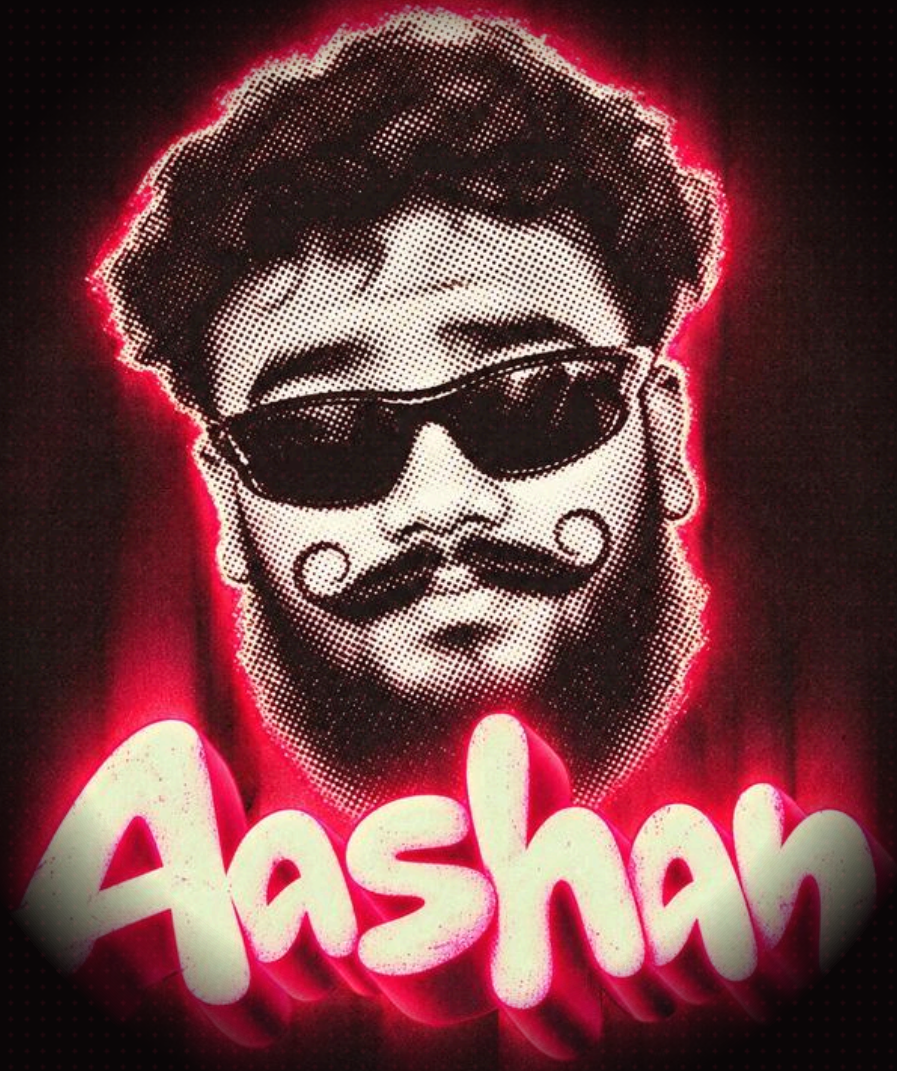




THE MONEY APP THAT ADMITS WHEN IT DOESN'T KNOW

Four sources. One honest ledger. Every number one tap from the transactions it came from.

PITCH DECK v1 · SEPTEMBER 2026

BUILT IN KOCHI, KERALA · STILL ONE GUY

THE ENTIRE COMPANY, ONE SLIDE

YOU BOUGHT LUNCH ONCE. YOUR APP COUNTED IT TWICE.

YOUR PHONE SAID

₹348

SMS, 6:41 pm

YOUR BANK SAID

₹348

statement, 2 days later

EVERY OTHER APP

₹696

two lunches. you had one.

AASHAN

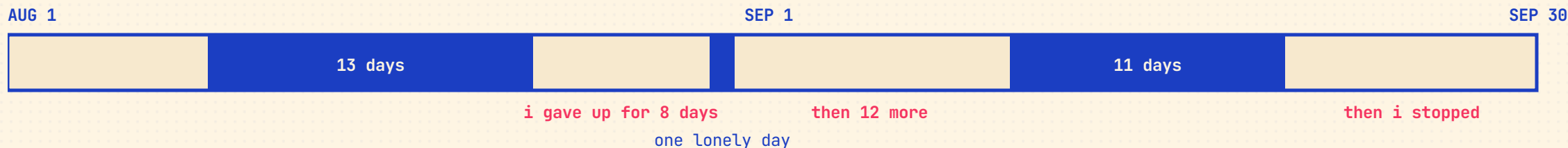
₹348

one lunch. one row.

Every finance app in India reads from more than one place and quietly counts the same rupee twice. We built the deeply boring machinery that stops that happening. That is the moat. Everything else on this slide deck is decoration.

WHY THIS EXISTS • A TRUE STORY

I TRACKED EVERY RUPEE I SPENT. FOR 25 DAYS. OUT OF 61.



the spreadsheet kept doing maths anyway

It said food cost me ₹3,663/month. It also said ₹333/day, in the same sentence, as if those were the same fact. They are 2.8× apart. At ₹333/day, eating every day is ₹10,100/month.

i believed the spreadsheet

It then compared my ₹3,663 to a “typical Kochi student’s ₹6,500” and told me I was frugal. I was not frugal. I had just stopped writing things down.

A NUMBER WITH NO DENOMINATOR IS A RUMOUR.

THE LIE EVERY MONEY APP TELLS

THEY DIVIDE BY THE DAYS THAT MAKE THEM LOOK GOOD.

WHAT THE APP SHOWS YOU

₹3,663/month

total ÷ 2 calendar months
(including the 36 days it saw nothing)

WHAT IS ACTUALLY HAPPENING

₹10,100/month

₹333/day × the days you actually eat
(which is all of them, you eat every day)

Nobody is lying on purpose. Everybody is dividing by a number they never show you. **Aashan's rule #1: every number ships with the days it was computed over, or it doesn't ship.**

"₹333/day across 22 observed days · 4 days unobserved" ← this is the whole feature. it is also the hardest one to sell to investors.

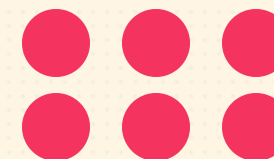
THE 94% PROBLEM

YOUR BANK CAN DESCRIBE 6 OF YOUR 93 PURCHASES.

87 TRANSACTIONS OF ₹20-₹110 · chai, lunch, a water can · 94% of count, 58% of your money



THE 6 YOUR BANK SEES



groceries · household
petrol · subscription
a domain · Onam fund

42% of the money.
6% of your life.

WHAT YOUR BANK ACTUALLY WRITES DOWN

UPI/9847xxxxxx@ybl/PAYMENT

It does not say “lunch”. It will never say “lunch”. It is not trying to say “lunch”.

SO WHY DOES EVERY APP START WITH THE BANK?

Because connecting a bank account is a demo you can show an investor in 30 seconds. Reading 6 pages of a 93-page book and writing the review is faster than reading the book.

EVERY INDIAN EXPENSE TRACKER EVENTUALLY BECOMES A LOAN APP.

Walnut

read your SMS. genuinely good. acquired by a lending company in 2017.

Money View

started as an SMS expense tracker. is now, primarily, a lender.

Mint (US)

the biggest PFM on earth. Intuit shut it down in Jan 2024 and pushed users to Credit Karma.

the neobanks

Fi, Jupiter, CRED. beautiful dashboards, attached to a business that needs you to borrow.

The pattern isn't villainy, it's arithmetic. **Tracking doesn't monetise.** So the tracker becomes the top of a lending funnel, and the day that happens the product stops being on your side — because now the app makes more money when you spend more.

We're going to charge you ₹149 a month instead. Fewer users. Zero conflict of interest. (also, honestly, we'd be terrible at running a lending business)

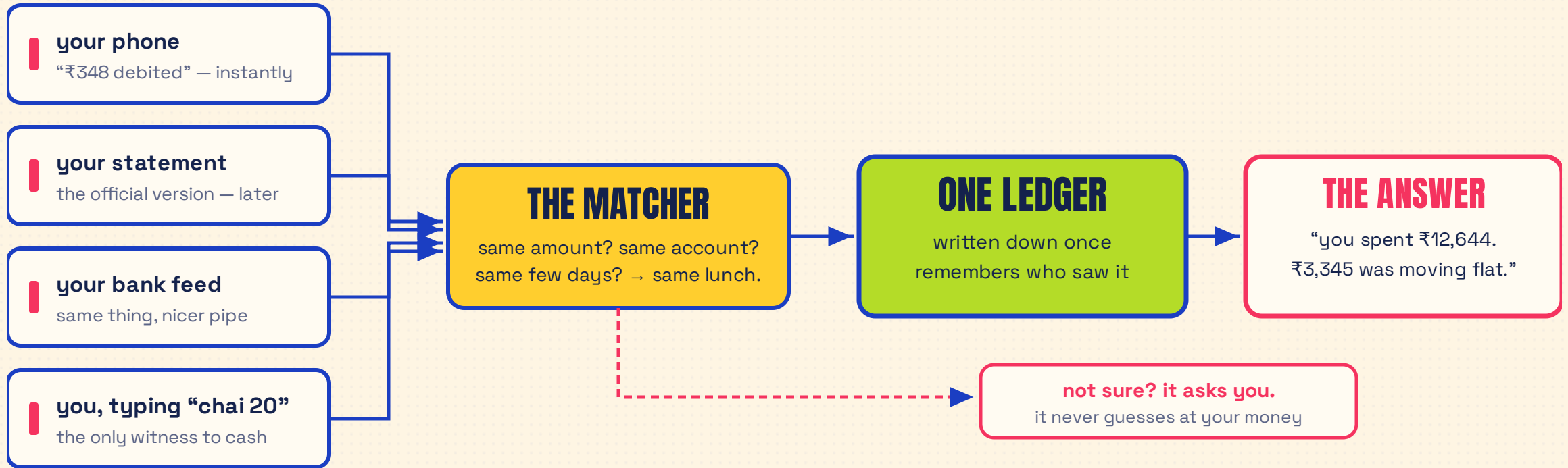
SO WHAT IS IT

**AASHAN TAKES EVERY PLACE YOUR MONEY
LEAVES A TRACE — YOUR TEXTS, YOUR
STATEMENTS, YOUR BANK FEED, AND YOUR
MEMORY — AND TURNS THEM INTO ONE
HONEST LEDGER THAT CAN EXPLAIN
ITSELF.**

Not a dashboard. Dashboards show you a pie chart of a number you already knew. Aashan tells you why the number is what it is, which parts of it are real, and what it couldn't see.



FOUR WITNESSES. ONE TRUTH.



Nobody saw it at all? Then it says so —
instead of pretending the day was free.

PART TWO

THE FIVE THINGS NOBODY ELSE DOES

(there are more. these are the ones that would survive a competitor
copying us for a year.)

STANDOUT FEATURE 01

THE DENOMINATOR

Every single number in Aashan carries the days it was computed over. Not in a settings menu. Not in a footnote. On the number.

It sounds like nothing. It is the difference between a fact and a vibe. It is also the only feature here that **makes us look worse** than our competitors on a marketing screenshot, which is exactly why nobody else will build it.

**WE WOULD RATHER SHOW YOU A SMALLER, TRUE NUMBER
THAN A BIGGER, CONFIDENT ONE.**

EVERY OTHER APP

₹333/day

divided by ??? days. good luck.

AASHAN

₹333/day

across 22 observed days

4 days unobserved • cash may be missing

THE WHY ENGINE

Every other app charts your total. Aashan argues with it.

WHAT A DASHBOARD SAYS

₹12,644

“Food 58%. Shopping 26%. Other 16%.”
cool. so am i fine or not.

WHAT AASHAN SAYS

“Your ₹12,644 is really **₹4,650 of ordinary life** plus **₹3,345 of moving into a flat once**. That move-in was 26% of two months and it will not happen again. Your daily food is big because it repeats every day, not because any meal is expensive — the most expensive thing you ate cost ₹109.”

↳ tap “₹3,345” → the two transactions. tap “₹109” → the receipt. every claim is one tap from its evidence.

Under the hood this is boring arithmetic — recurring-vs-one-off decomposition, outlier attribution, counterfactual subtraction. **No LLM computes any of it.** That is a feature, and slide 17 explains why.

FIVE-SECOND CASH

94% of the transactions in my own life were ₹20–₹110 and mostly cash or a UPI transfer to a man with a tea stall.

Every competitor treats cash as an afterthought — a form, six fields, a dropdown, a save button. **We treat it as the primary source, because the data says it is.**

honest risk: people stop entering cash after week three. that's the single biggest product risk we have. our answer isn't nagging — it's **the coverage map**, which just tells you the truth about what it stopped seeing. next slide.

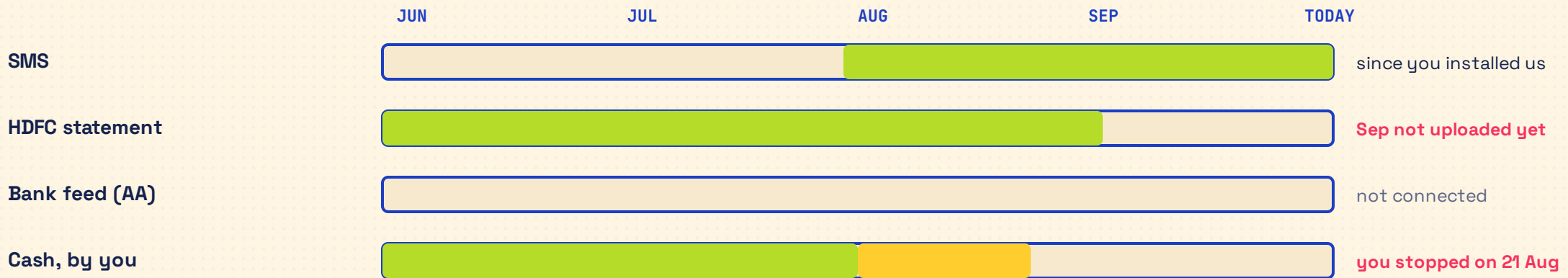
THE ENTIRE INTERACTION

1. open
2. type “65 water”
3. done

no category dropdown — it guesses, you fix it later if you care
no date picker — it's today
no save button — typing is saving
widget + share-sheet + one-tap repeat of yesterday's chai

THE COVERAGE MAP

The screen where the app tells you what it **can't** see. No other finance app has this screen. We think that's mad.



So: September's total is real for cards, missing for cash, and we will say so on every September number until you fix it.

it kills the biggest lie in PFM

"Your spending went down this month!" No it didn't. You stopped logging.

it makes nagging unnecessary

We don't guilt you into logging. We just decline to pretend.

it's a trust machine

An app that admits limits is an app you believe when it doesn't.

WE WILL NEVER SELL YOU A LOAN.

the promise, specifically

- ◆ no lending, ever
- ◆ no credit cards, no “pre-approved offers”
- ◆ no insurance leads, no mutual fund commissions
- ◆ no selling or sharing your data. not anonymised. not aggregated. not “with partners”.

what we actually delete

- ◆ the PDF you upload — gone after we read it
- ◆ its password — never written to disk at all
- ◆ the raw SMS text — gone after we extract the amount
- ◆ the encrypted bank payload and its keys — gone after decryption

what survives: the transaction. yours.
exportable. deletable. that's the honest
version.

so how do you eat

You pay us ₹149/month. That's it. That's the business model.

The moment we make money when you spend more, we've become the thing we're replacing.

EVERY FINANCE APP IN INDIA IS A LOAN COMPANY WEARING A DASHBOARD AS A HAT.

THINGS WE REFUSE TO BUILD

A product is defined by what it says no to. Here is our no.

streaks

Your finances are not Duolingo. Missing a day is not a moral failure.

“you spent ₹200 on coffee!”

You know. You were there. We’re not your mother.

comparison to strangers

“The average Kochi student spends ₹6,500” is a number from a blog. We’ll compare you to you.

a chatbot that invents numbers

The LLM writes sentences. It does not do sums. Slide 17.

goals nobody sets

The most-built and least-used feature in this entire category.

a credit score widget

That widget exists to sell loans. See previous slide re: hats.

we will get asked for all six of these. we will say no six times. this slide exists so we remember why.

PART THREE

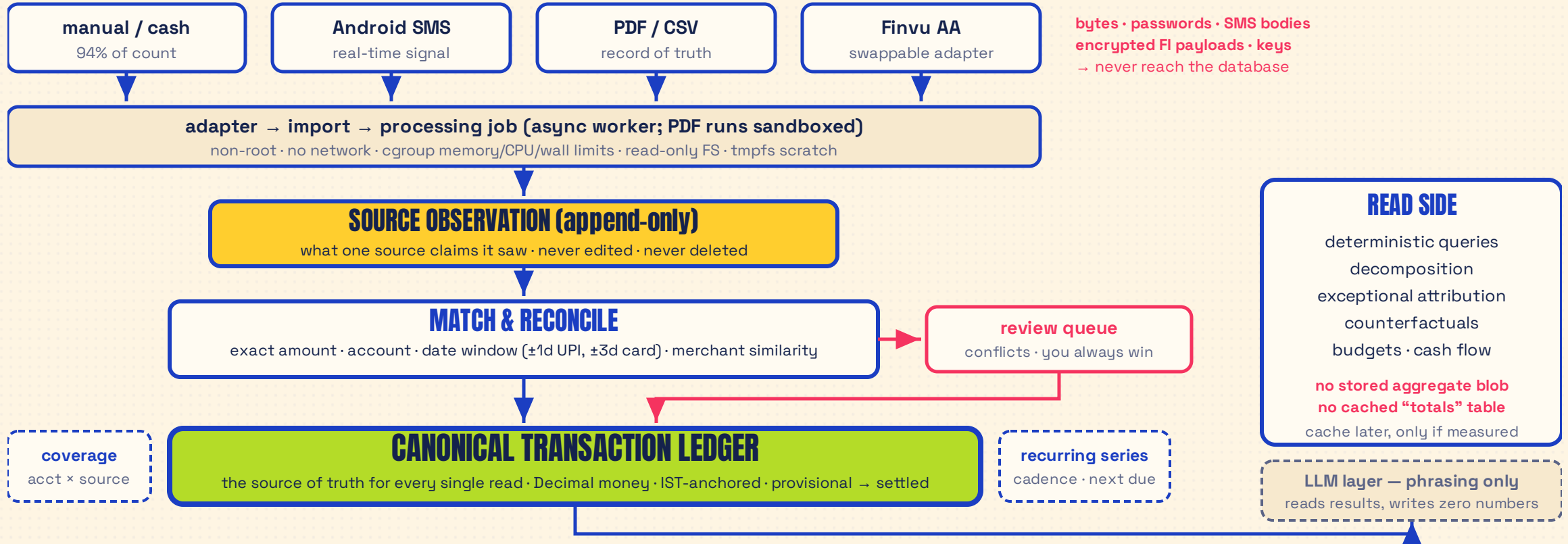
FOR THE PEOPLE IN THE REPLIES

everything after this is for the guy who is
already typing "why not rust" into a comment box.

hi. we thought about it. here's the working.

FOUR SOURCES, ONE APPEND-ONLY LOG, ONE LEDGER, ZERO MAGIC

SOURCES – raw material, destroyed after extraction



THE ONE IDEA THE WHOLE THING RESTS ON

A TRANSACTION IS NOT A ROW YOU INSERT. IT'S A CONCLUSION YOU REACH.

HOW WE BUILT IT FIRST (WRONG)

```
UNIQUE (user_id, source, external_id)
```

The source is **part of the key**. So SMS-₹348 and statement-₹348 can never collide — not because our matching is weak, but because **the schema makes it impossible**. Two rows. ₹696. The bug on slide 2, in one line of DDL.

HOW IT HAS TO WORK

```
observation → match(amount, account, window)
hit → attach observation to txn
miss → create txn, attach observation
```

Deduplication stops being “drop the row” and becomes “add a witness”. One mechanism now handles overlapping statements, cross-source confirmation, provenance, and conflict — instead of four special cases.

IT'S EVENT SOURCING — observations are the immutable event log, the ledger is the projection. We just don't need Kafka to do it, because events arrive at human speed and the projection lives in the same Postgres transaction as the event. You get atomic merges instead of eventual consistency you'd then have to fight.

AND IT'S AUDITABLE — “why does this say ₹348?” has an answer: two observations, matched at 22:14 on a ±1 day UPI window, statement won on amount, SMS kept its timestamp. Nothing about a user's money is ever unexplainable.

“WHY DIDN'T YOU JUST USE ____”

THE OBJECTION

THE ANSWER

“Python? in 2026? use Go or Rust.”

Throughput isn't the constraint — a heavy user makes ~150 transactions a month. The hot path is one indexed Postgres query and a date bucket. The two genuinely hard problems are parsing a hostile PDF without getting owned, and not counting money twice; neither is solved by a faster language. The one place performance matters is the parser, and the answer there is a **process boundary with seccomp and cgroup limits**, not a rewrite. Python also has the best PDF-extraction ecosystem that exists, which is the actual bottleneck skill.

“Postgres won't scale, use ClickHouse.”

150 rows/user/month. A million users is ~1.8B rows/year — Postgres handles that with monthly partitioning and a BRIN index on transaction_at. More importantly, reconciliation needs to merge two observations **atomically**, which an analytical store won't give us. Column store is a problem for the day we have the problem.

“Supabase is vendor lock-in.”

What we actually use is Postgres, GoTrue-issued JWTs, and RLS — all portable. The lock-in surface is the issuer URL and auth.uid() in policy bodies: about a day's work. Writing our own auth for a financial product is the bigger risk. **But:** RLS must be FORCED and the app must connect as a non-owning role, or it's decorative — which is a real bug in our code right now, on slide 20.

“Why embeddings instead of an LLM for categories?”

Cost, determinism, privacy. An LLM classifier bills per transaction, can't be unit-tested because it isn't deterministic, and ships your transaction descriptions to a third party — which torches the entire privacy pitch. A pinned 22 MB MiniLM runs locally, returns a cosine score you can assert in CI, and won't silently re-categorise last month when a vendor ships a new model.

“Just use an Account Aggregator and skip all this.”

AA would have captured **6 of my 93 transactions**. Also, being an FIU requires an RBI/SEBI/IRDAI/PFRDA licence we do not hold — 5–10 months and ₹5–25 lakh, per published guidance. Building the product on AA means building on a permit we don't have.

“float vs Decimal, who cares.”

Postgres stores NUMERIC(18,2), our Python used float, and dev-on-SQLite stores REAL — so dev and prod can disagree on a rounded total. We're also about to validate statement balance continuity, which flakes on 0.01 representation error. Money is Decimal or integer paise. Not pedantry: the difference between a validator that works and one that lies.

“Microservices? Kubernetes?”

Exactly one process boundary earns its keep: the PDF parser, because it eats attacker-controlled input. That's a

WHERE THE AI IS AND ISN'T

THE LLM MAY WRITE ENGLISH. IT MAY NOT WRITE A NUMBER.

DETERMINISTIC, ALWAYS

Every total, average and percentage. Duplicate matching. Transfer detection. Recurring detection. Budgets. Balance validation. Coverage. And the decision that something needs your review.

AI-ASSISTED, REVERSIBLE

Turning BHARATPE9847 into “the tea shop”. First-pass category for a description no rule has seen. Turning “how much on food in August” into a query. Phrasing facts that are already computed.

NEVER, UNDER ANY PRESSURE

Computing or adjusting an amount. Deciding what’s a duplicate. Deciding budget inclusion. Writing to the ledger. Generating a savings figure. Anything you can’t trace back to transactions.

Every competitor is about to ship “AI insights” that hallucinate a number with total confidence. **We will ship the same sentences, with the arithmetic done by a computer, correctly, like god intended.** When ours says ₹3,345, you can tap it and see the two transactions.

WHAT'S BUILT, AND WHAT'S CURRENTLY ON FIRE

We audited ourselves before a user did. Here is the unedited result.

SHIPPED & TESTED

- ◆ FastAPI backend, ownership derived from a validated Supabase JWT — never from the request body
- ◆ 17-table schema, versioned migrations for Postgres *and* SQLite
- ◆ CSV ingestion through a real import → job → candidate → transaction path with checkpoints
- ◆ Transaction state properly split: lifecycle / classification / budget / transfer / duplicate
- ◆ Review APIs, user merchant rules that beat the global classifier, local embedding categorisation
- ◆ A full Setu AA adapter, end to end, with webhook idempotency
- ◆ **36 of 38 tests passing** (the 2 need Streamlit installed)

ON FIRE 🔥

- ◆ Totals are computed **per import, not per user** — import ₹500 then ₹300 and the dashboard proudly shows ₹300
- ◆ Dedupe key includes the source, so cross-source matching is **structurally impossible**
- ◆ The review queue exists, works, and is **unreachable from any real code path**
- ◆ The webhook has **no authentication of any kind**
- ◆ RLS is enabled but not FORCED, and the app owns the tables — so it's exempt from its own policies
- ◆ The privacy screen still claims we don't store descriptions. We do. Since Part 2.
- ◆ There is no git repository. None. Zero.

A deck that hid this would be a worse signal than the bugs are. **All seven are scheduled in Phase 1** — next slide — and none of them are hard. They're just the difference between a demo and a product that handles other people's money.

BORING FIRST. LOUD LATER.

PHASE 1 • 6 WEEKS

the boring correct core

- ◆ ledger becomes the read model
- ◆ observations + real matching
- ◆ reachable review queue
- ◆ async worker
- ◆ coverage windows
- ◆ webhook auth, forced RLS, git, deletion

users: 1. it's me. exit: the ₹500+₹300 test passes.

PHASE 2 • 6 WEEKS

SMS + five-second cash

- ◆ Android SMS ingestion
- ◆ Play permissions declaration filed
- ◆ notification-listener fallback built
- ◆ the capture widget
- ◆ first real reconciliation across two live sources

users: ~20 friends. exit: someone who isn't me logs cash for 3 weeks.

PHASE 3 • 8 WEEKS

statements + the why engine

- ◆ sandboxed PDF worker
- ◆ HDFC • SBI • ICICI • Federal • Axis parsers
- ◆ balance-continuity validation
- ◆ recurring series
- ◆ ONE authenticated frontend

users: 100 private beta. exit: someone pays.

PHASE 4 • ONGOING

finvu, polish, noise

- ◆ Finvu adapter on UAT + local ReBIT simulator
- ◆ LLM phrasing layer
- ◆ public launch
- ◆ the social account becomes a problem for someone

AA licence runs as a business track – never a code dependency.

Note what is not in Phase 1: any new ingestion source. You cannot reconcile three sources on a pipeline that can't correctly add two imports together. **Everyone builds the sources first. That's why everyone's numbers are wrong.**

THINGS THAT WILL GO WRONG

WE KNOW. HERE'S THE WORKING.

RISK	THE ACTUAL SITUATION	WHAT WE DO ABOUT IT
Google bans SMS reading	Google Play restricts the SMS permission group, but “ SMS-based money management ” is a listed permitted use case for apps that track and manage a budget using READ_SMS / RECEIVE_SMS only. A policy update lands 27 Jan 2027 , tightening call-log access rather than SMS.	File the Permissions Declaration Form early and stay narrow (no call log, ever). Fallback already designed: NotificationListenerService reads the notification shade and needs no SMS permission group at all.
We never get AA access	Only RBI/SEBI/IRDAI/PFRDA-regulated entities can be FIUs. We are a personal finance app. We are none of those things.	AA is source 4 of 4 and the product is complete without it. Build against Finvu UAT and a local ReBIT simulator; pursue a regulated partner on a separate track that no sprint depends on.
A malicious PDF owns the server	Decompression bombs, malformed xref tables, 900MB of nested streams. Bank statements are attacker-controllable input the moment we accept uploads.	Parser runs non-root, with no network, hard memory/CPU/wall caps, read-only filesystem, tmpfs scratch, in a process that is allowed to die. Passwords live in memory and never touch disk.
Bank formats drift and parsers rot	Every bank redesigns its statement eventually, usually without telling anyone.	Explicit per-bank parsers with a stated confidence and a generic fallback. Balance continuity is validated arithmetically. Low confidence goes to review — never silently into your totals.
People stop logging cash	This is the biggest one, and it’s a product risk, not a technical one. Manual tracking decayed after 13 days in the founder’s own spreadsheet.	Make it five seconds. Then be honest when it decays — that’s what coverage is for. We’d rather show a gap than invent a zero.
A big neobank copies us	They can copy the screens in a quarter.	They cannot copy “we don’t sell loans”, because loans are their revenue. The honest-numbers position is structurally unavailable to a lender. That’s the whole strategy.

THE LEAST EXCITING BUSINESS MODEL IN FINTECH

FREE FOREVER

₹0

- ◆ manual + SMS capture
- ◆ one account
- ◆ current month
- ◆ the coverage map, always

genuinely useful, not a trap

AASHAN FULL

₹149/mo

- ◆ statement upload & parsing
- ◆ unlimited history & accounts
- ◆ the Why Engine
- ◆ recurring detection
- ◆ full export, any time

₹1,199/year · student ₹79/mo

THE MATH

3,000 paying users ≈ ₹53 lakh a year. That funds a small team in Kochi indefinitely.

That is the entire plan. Not a unicorn. A business.

For scale: UPI processed **24.5 billion transactions in August 2026**. We need three thousand people who want their own numbers to be true.

The reason this matters isn't frugality, it's incentives. A subscription is the only model where **we win when your numbers are accurate** rather than when your spending is high. Every alternative — lending, affiliate cards, data — pays us to make you worse off.

THE VOICE

A FINTECH THAT POSTS LIKE A MINECRAFT HOST

The category's entire personality is a stock photo of a couple looking relieved about a home loan. We're going the other way: deadpan, self-aware, chronically online, technically correct.

THE THREE RULES

- 1 – we punch at banks and at ourselves. never at the user.
- 2 – we never fake a number for engagement. not one. not ever.
- 3 – if we're down, we say we're down, and we're funny about it.

the joke is the distribution. the correctness is the product. a brand this loud only survives if the numbers underneath are the most careful in the category – which is the actual reason slides 15-20 exist.

POSTS THAT ARE ALREADY WRITTEN

"your bank statement is a PDF locked with your date of birth. in 2026. anyway, we parse it."

"we shipped a feature where the app says *i don't know*. our investors have not called back."

"no we will not give you a loan. no. we don't have any money either."

"someone asked if we use AI. yes – to write sentences. the maths is done by a computer, correctly, like god intended."

"app's down. i am one guy. the ledger is fine, we don't lose money, only vibes."

THAT'S THE DECK

**EVERYONE ELSE IS
GUESSING CONFIDENTLY.
WE'D RATHER BE
RIGHT, OUT LOUD.**

Aashan is a personal finance product for people who have been quietly lied to by a pie chart. Four sources, one honest ledger, every number one tap from its evidence, and a company that makes money only when you keep believing it.

built in Kochi · Phase 1 starts the day this deck closes · still one
guy · aashan.app

